

serious modern work. Slow and meditative throughout, it features a soprano singing three Polish texts concerned with the themes of suffering and war. Górecki himself was unable to explain the symphony's popularity and was rather bewildered by his newfound fame. He was a devout Catholic and some critics have linked his work with that of other spiritually minded composers of the time (notably Pärt and Tavener) under the heading "holy Minimalism." The serenity of their work seems to many listeners an antidote to the harshness of much modern music.

KEY WORKS: Two Sacred Songs, 1971; Symphony No. 3 ("Symphony of Sorrowful Songs"), 1976; Miserere, 1981

Krzysztof Penderecki

born 1933, POLISH

Penderecki is one of the most acclaimed composers of his time and is unusual among avant-garde artists in that his work has appealed to a large public from virtually the beginning of his career—a reflection of the powerful way in which he conveys his humanitarian views. He came to international attention with Threnody for the